



AMERICAN
ROCKETRY
CHALLENGE

Registration System Guide



AEROSPACE INDUSTRIES ASSOCIATION
& NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF ROCKETRY



Welcome to American Rocketry Challenge

Congratulations!

You're ready to open an application or have already started to complete your registration forms!

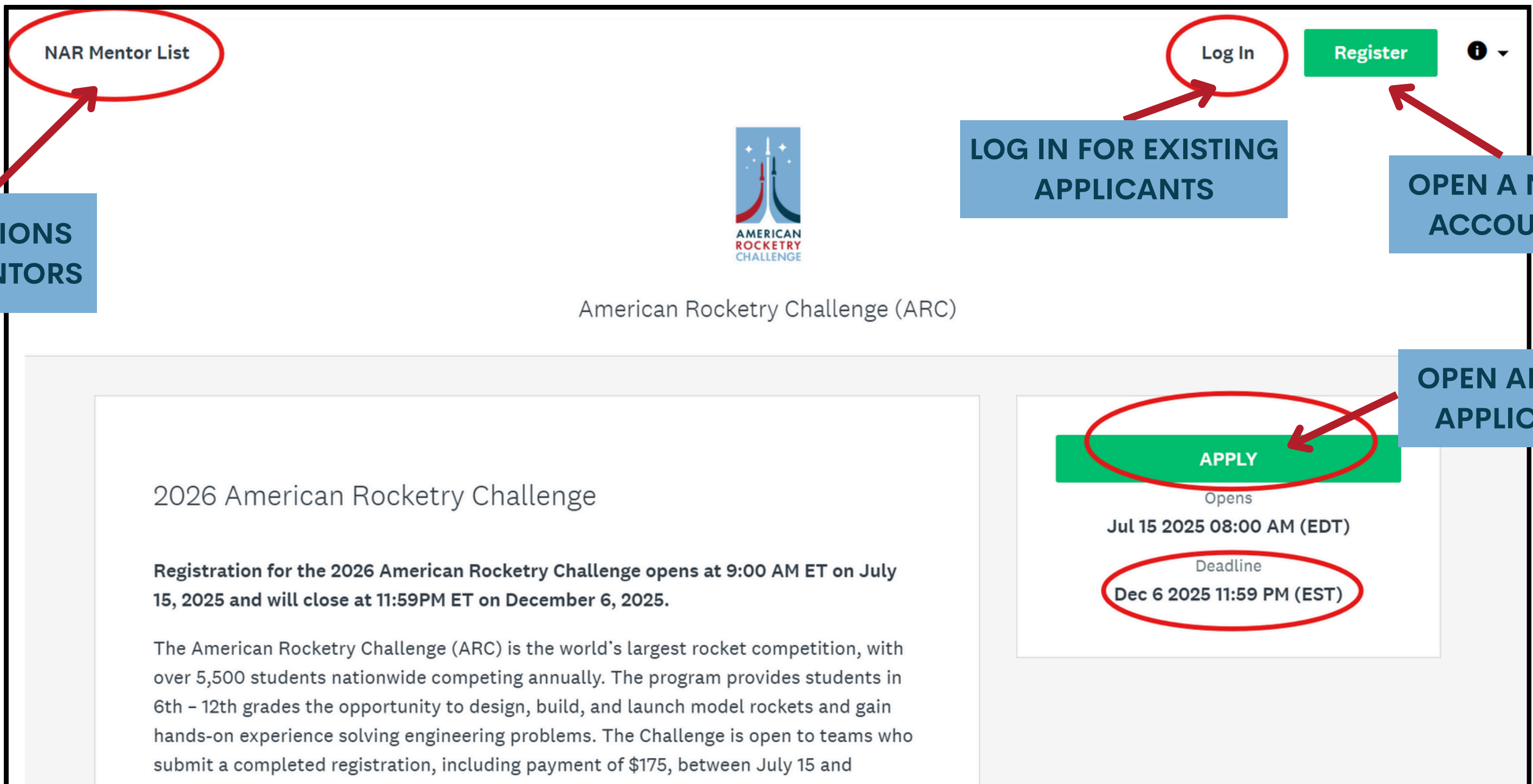
This walkthrough is a step-by-step guide to open and fully register for the challenge. If you have questions after reviewing this walkthrough, please email us at:

rocketrychallenge@aia-aerospace.org

Please note that currently only students residing in the U.S. can register for this competition.

Key Features of the Log-in Screen

https://rocketrychallenge.smapply.io/prog/2026_american_rocketry_challenge/



The screenshot shows the American Rocketry Challenge (ARC) website interface. At the top, the ARC logo is centered. Below it, the text "American Rocketry Challenge (ARC)" is displayed. On the right side, there are two buttons: "Log In" and "Register". The "Log In" button is circled in red, and a blue box labeled "LOG IN FOR EXISTING APPLICANTS" has an arrow pointing to it. The "Register" button is also circled in red, and a blue box labeled "OPEN A NEW ACCOUNT" has an arrow pointing to it. On the left side, there is a link labeled "NAR Mentor List", which is circled in red, and a blue box labeled "LOCATIONS OF MENTORS" has an arrow pointing to it. In the bottom right corner, there is a green button labeled "APPLY", which is circled in red, and a blue box labeled "OPEN ANOTHER APPLICATION" has an arrow pointing to it. Below the "APPLY" button, the text "Opens Jul 15 2025 08:00 AM (EDT)" is displayed. Below that, the text "Deadline Dec 6 2025 11:59 PM (EST)" is displayed, with "Deadline" circled in red. On the left side of the main content area, there is a section titled "2026 American Rocketry Challenge" with the following text: "Registration for the 2026 American Rocketry Challenge opens at 9:00 AM ET on July 15, 2025 and will close at 11:59PM ET on December 6, 2025." and "The American Rocketry Challenge (ARC) is the world's largest rocket competition, with over 5,500 students nationwide competing annually. The program provides students in 6th - 12th grades the opportunity to design, build, and launch model rockets and gain hands-on experience solving engineering problems. The Challenge is open to teams who submit a completed registration, including payment of \$175, between July 15 and".

LOCATIONS OF MENTORS

LOG IN FOR EXISTING APPLICANTS

OPEN A NEW ACCOUNT

OPEN ANOTHER APPLICATION

2026 American Rocketry Challenge

Registration for the 2026 American Rocketry Challenge opens at 9:00 AM ET on July 15, 2025 and will close at 11:59PM ET on December 6, 2025.

The American Rocketry Challenge (ARC) is the world's largest rocket competition, with over 5,500 students nationwide competing annually. The program provides students in 6th - 12th grades the opportunity to design, build, and launch model rockets and gain hands-on experience solving engineering problems. The Challenge is open to teams who submit a completed registration, including payment of \$175, between July 15 and

APPLY

Opens
Jul 15 2025 08:00 AM (EDT)

Deadline
Dec 6 2025 11:59 PM (EST)



Landing Page (After Creating and Verifying an Account)

CONTACT A ROCKETRY
MENTOR

GET TECHNICAL
SUPPORT

American Rocketry Challenge (ARC)

Pages Programs My Applications Caitlin Sullivan

Find an NAR Rocketry Mentor

0 of 9 required tasks complete

Last edited: Oct 18 2025 11:50 AM (EDT)

REVIEW SUBMIT

Deadline: Dec 6 2025 11:59 PM (EST)

CS Caitlin Sullivan (Owner)
caisulliwork@yahoo.com

Add collaborator

2026 American Rocketry Challen... Preview

26-0000001221

Status: Registration Open

APPLICATION ACTIVITY

Your tasks

- Important Registration Information
- School/Organization and Adult Team Advisor Information
- Team Information Form
- Team Member List
- Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team

EDIT YOUR ACCOUNT

START YOUR
FIRST TASK

GIVE
SOMEONE
ELSE ACCESS

Complete or Reset a Task and View Completion Status

GET TECHNICAL
SUPPORT

American Rocketry Challenge (ARC) Pages Programs My Applications Caitlin Sullivan

< Back to application

2026 American Rocketry Challenge
26-0000001221
ID: 26-0000001221 | Status: Registration Open

☒ Important Registration Information

☒ School/Organization and Adult Team Advisor Information

☐ Team Information Form

☐ Team Member List

Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian

School/Organization and Adult Team Advisor Information

School / Organization Information

0% Download Reset

School or Nonprofit Organization Information

All teams must have a sponsoring school or non-profit educational organization who gives permission to the team to function and permission to the Adult Team Advisor to work with the students. Please provide information about this group below.

If you have more than one team, please ensure you enter the following information the same on every application.

School or Organization (Full Official Name): School Name

Address 1:

Address 2:

COMPLETION
STATUS

ERASE ALL
RESPONSES

BEGIN
TYPING

Editing a Task You Marked as Complete

GET TECHNICAL
SUPPORT

American Rocketry Challenge (ARC) Pages Programs My Applications Caitlin Sullivan

< Back to application

2026 American Rocketry Challenge
26-0000001221
ID: 26-0000001221 | Status: Registration Open

- ✓ Important Registration Information
- 🔄 School/Organization and Adult Team Advisor Information
- 🔄 Team Information Form
- ✓ **Team Member List**
- 🔄 Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member

Team Member List
Completed On 18 2025 12:47 PM (EDT)

Task instructions Hide

Please provide a list of students currently on your team. You will be able to until you submit your Registration. After submitting your registration form, to change your team makeup in the "Team Changes" Stage. All changes must be made prior to Qualification Flights and all team members who are listed at that point are eligible for award funds.

Form: Team Member List

How many students are on your team? **All teams must have between 3 and 10 members.**

Please note: When you choose a number here and mark this task as complete, the correct number of permission form requests will appear in your task list. If you decide to change the number of team members later, you can reopen this task, choose a new number, and click "Mark as Complete" again. The number of permission form requests will adjust to the new number. If you do not "Mark as Complete" again after making the change, the number of permission request forms will not adjust.

3

Which describes the grade levels of your team?

SELECT THE
COMPLETED
TASK

CLICK ON THE
ELLIPSIS (3 DOTS)

THEN CLICK
EDIT



Request Guardian Permission Form

Referred to as "Recommendation."
System does not allow us to change this term.

GET TECHNICAL SUPPORT

SELECT TASK

American Rocketry Challenge (ARC) Pages Programs My Applications Caitlin Sullivan

< Back to application

2026 American Rocketry Challenge
26-0000001221
ID: 26-0000001221 | Status: Registration Open

- ✓ Important Registration Information
- 📄 School/Organization and Adult Team Advisor Information
- 📄 Team Information Form
- 📄 Team Member List
- 📄 Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member

Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member

Task instructions Hide

Team Member 1 must have parental or guardian permission to participate. This permission will no longer be collected via paper form, but submitted electronically. Enter an email address for the parent or guardian and they will receive a unique link to complete the form.

Please note: Although the system calls parents/guardians a "recommender," this is just a request for a permission form.

REQUEST A RECOMMENDATION

Recommendations

0 recommendations
Minimum: 1 | Maximum: 1

MARK AS COMPLETE

PLEASE NOTE EXPLANATION

REQUEST A NEW PERMISSION FORM

ONCE RECEIVED, MARK TASK AS COMPLETE

Send a Request to a Guardian

ENTER GUARDIAN
INFORMATION

WRITE A MESSAGE TO
THE GUARDIAN

i Task instructions Hide

Team Member 1 must have parental or guardian permission to participate. This permission will no longer be collected via paper form, but submitted electronically. Enter an email address for the parent or guardian and they will receive a unique link to complete the form.

Please note: Although the system calls parents/guardians a "recommender," this is just a request for a permission form.

First name

Last name

Email

Message

**GUARDIAN WILL
RECEIVE AN EMAIL
FROM
ROCKETRYCHALLENGE@
AIA-AEROSPACE.ORG**

Resend, Withdraw, or Delete a Permission Form Request

American Rocketry Challenge (ARC) Pages Programs My Applications Caitlin Sullivan

< Back to application

2026 American Rocketry Challenge
26-0000001221
ID: 26-0000001221 | Status: Registration Open

- ✓ Important Registration Information
- School/Organization and Adult Team Advisor Information
- Team Information Form
- Team Member List
- Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member

1 of 9 required tasks complete

Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member

Task instructions Hide

Team Member 1 must have parental or guardian permission to participate. This permission will no longer be collected via paper form, but submitted electronically. Enter an email address for the parent or guardian and they will receive a unique link to complete the form.

Please note: Although the system calls parents/guardians a "recommender," this is just a request for a permission form.

Recommendations

Caitlin Sullivan
caitlin.sullivan@aia-aerospace.org

Requested: Oct 18 2025

0 recommendations
Minimum: 1 | Maximum: 1

MARK AS COMPLETE

Resend request
Withdraw request

RESEND, WITHDRAW
OR DELETE A REQUEST

NOTE: ONE REQUEST ALLOWED - DELETE ANY
WITHDRAWN REQUESTS TO ADD ANOTHER

STATUS OF REQUEST

Troubleshooting Permission Forms

If Guardian Does Not Receive Request:

- Ask them to check their spam/junk folder
- Have them ask their email administrator to add rocketrychallenge@aia-aerospace.org to their "permitted sender" list
- Ask if they have a different email address you could use on a different domain (gmail, yahoo, etc.)
- Use the "i" icon in the upper right corner of the screen to contact technical support and receive a one-time link from tech support (they have a different email address):
 - Click "Contact Support" and select "Something isn't working as expected."
 - Select "Emails" and then "An Email Wasn't Received."
 - Explain the problem and be sure to check the box indicating you would like a call-back if you would like tech support to call you.

Parent / Guardian Email Request

Guardians will receive an email from rocketrychallenge@aia-aerospace.org and click the 'view recommendation' button in their email.

THE MESSAGE YOU
ENTERED IN THE
REQUEST APPEARS HERE

****Unfortunately, the system is only able to call this a recommendation, even though it is only a permission form.****

American Rocketry Challenge (ARC)

Dear Parent or Guardian,

Caitlin Sullivan has invited you to provide Parent or Guardian Permission Form for your child as part of their registration for the following program: **2026 American Rocketry Challenge**.

Message from Caitlin:

*This is Ms. Smith. Please complete this Permission form for Jeremy. It is not an actual **recommendation** - that is just what the system calls it. Thanks!*

Instructions for giving this **recommendation:**

Hello! You are receiving this email because your child would like to participate in the American Rocketry Challenge. The Adult Team Advisor has sent you a **request** for parental or guardian permission for your child to participate. Please complete the following information.

Please note: Although the system calls you a "recommender," this is just a **request** for a permission form.

Please click the button below to accept this **request** and begin working on your **recommendation**.

Give **recommendation**

Number of Required Permission Forms

- You must have a permission form received (not just requested) for every student on your team in order to register.
- If you submit your registration without all permission forms, your application will be moved back to the Registration Open stage for you to complete this task.
- If you have the required minimum of 3 team members and 3 permission forms, you may proceed registering.
- In the Team Member Changes stage, you may add and remove team members and request new permission forms.

Troubleshooting Permission Forms

Help! My permission forms are in a different order than my Team Member List.

- No problem. They do not need to be in the same order. If it bothers you, you can change the order of your Team Member List. The order of permission forms cannot be changed once they are submitted unless you delete them and send new requests to guardians.

Help! My permission forms have a gap in one slot because I deleted a team member.

- It is fine if there is a gap (e.g. you have Forms A, B, C, and E completed, but not D.), but A, B, and C are required. Contact us if you are dropping one of these three.



- IF YOU SEE A GREEN CHECK HERE
 - BUT YOUR TEAM MEMBER BOX IS HALF FILLED OUT
- MAKE SURE TO HIT THE 'MARK AS COMPLETE' BUTTON IN THE BOTTOM RIGHT CORNER!**

[< Back to application](#)

2026 American Rocketry Challenge
26-0000000013
ID: 26-0000000013 | Status: Team Member Changes (Prior to Qualifications)

✓

Team Member List

🔄

Team Member 1 - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission

✓

Team Member 2 - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission

✓

Team Member 3 - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission

3 of 4 tasks complete

Last edited: Sep 22 2025 09:37 AM (EDT)

Team Member 1 - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission

Reuse data ⓘ ...

Task instructions Hide

Team Member 1 must have parental or guardian permission to participate. This permission will no longer be collected via paper form, but submitted electronically. Enter an email address for the parent or guardian and they will receive a unique link to complete the form.

Please note: Although the system calls parents/guardians a "recommender," this is just a request for a permission form.

Recommendations

Camryn Mackey
camrynmackey@gmail.com

✓ Received: Sep 22 2025 ... ▾

1 recommendations

Minimum: 1 | Maximum: 1

MARK AS COMPLETE



Payment

- The payment task will not be editable until you have completed all the other tasks.
- Payment can be made via Paypal or Check.

 **Select Payment Method** Completed Sep 9 2025 10:18 AM (EDT)

Select Payment Method

There is a \$175 entry fee per team. We use Paypal to process your payments and do not receive or store your billing information. Please select if you would like to pay by via Paypal (for credit and debit cards) or check. Please note that payment by check will delay the processing of your registration. We request that you only pay by check if you cannot pay by one of the other methods.

Note: Registration fees are non-refundable.

How would you like to pay?

☒ Check

 **Pay Entry Fee (Check)** Hidden from applicant Not Started

Task instructions

Pay Entry Fee

There is a \$175 entry fee per team. Please only pay by check if you are unable to pay by PayPal. Paying by check will delay the processing of your registration until the check is received.

On the memo line of your check, indicate the team number(s) for which you are paying entry fees. Failure to provide your team number may prevent us from processing your registration.

Your team number is 26-0000000010.

All checks should be made payable to the National Center for Advanced Technologies and mailed to:

NATIONAL CENTER FOR ADVANCED TECHNOLOGIES

ATTN: AMERICAN ROCKETRY CHALLENGE

1000 WILSON BLVD., SUITE 1700

ARLINGTON, VA 22209

Please Note: Registration Fees are non-refundable.

 **Pay Entry Fee (Paypal)** Hidden from applicant

Provider: paypal
Amount: 175
Currency: USD

Submission

- Once all tasks are completed, INCLUDING permission forms for all students on your team beyond the required 3, click submit on the left-hand side of the screen.

10 of 10 tasks complete

Last edited: Sep 9 2025 10:18 AM (EDT)

REVIEW **SUBMIT**

Deadline: Dec 6 2025 11:59 PM (EST)



Application Submitted!

Thank you for submitting your application. Applications are reviewed regularly for eligibility, completeness, and valid payments. During busy times we may experience a delay in application reviews. If your application has not been reviewed after five (5) business days, please contact us at rocketrychallenge@aia-aerospace.org.

Go to My Applications

OR

View more Programs

Pending Review Stage

Once you submit your application, you will be placed into the pending review stage.



In the pending review stage, the ARC team will review your application to ensure all information is correct and move you to the Team Member Changes Stage, where you will submit your final roster just prior to Qualifications.



Team Member Changes Stage

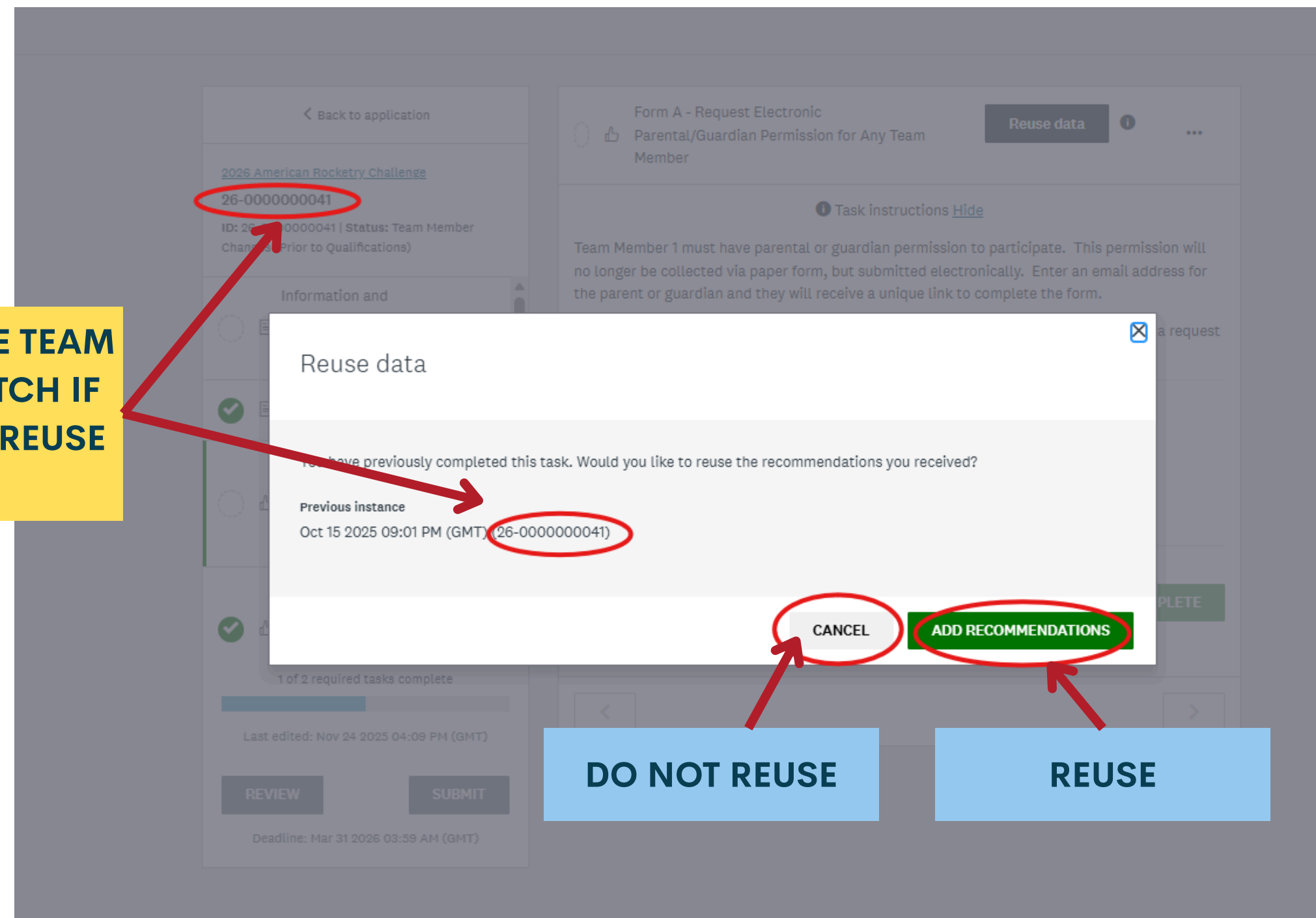
CONGRATULATIONS! Your team is fully registered for the American Rocketry Challenge! This stage is your opportunity to make changes to your team roster prior to qualification flights. You should stay in this stage until you are 100% certain your roster is final and submit is just before your qualification flights. If you don't plan to conduct your qualification flights until March, we recommend staying right here until then.

- There are no more paper add/drop forms as in past years.
- This stage is where you can make changes to your roster on your own.
- Once you submit this stage, your team roster can no longer be changed.
- Any students on your roster at this stage are eligible for awards and to attend finals if your team scores in the Top 100.

"Reuse Data" Feature

In this stage, the system will repopulate all your data from your registration if you are not making any changes. If you'd like, you can repopulate all your data and then change it as the season moves on.

**MAKE SURE THE TEAM
NUMBERS MATCH IF
YOU WANT TO REUSE
DATA**



Form A - Request Electronic
Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member

Reuse data

Task instructions [Hide](#)

Team Member 1 must have parental or guardian permission to participate. This permission will no longer be collected via paper form, but submitted electronically. Enter an email address for the parent or guardian and they will receive a unique link to complete the form.

Reuse data

You have previously completed this task. Would you like to reuse the recommendations you received?

Previous instance
Oct 15 2025 09:01 PM (GMT) (26-0000000041)

CANCEL ADD RECOMMENDATIONS

1 of 2 required tasks complete

Last edited: Nov 24 2025 04:09 PM (GMT)

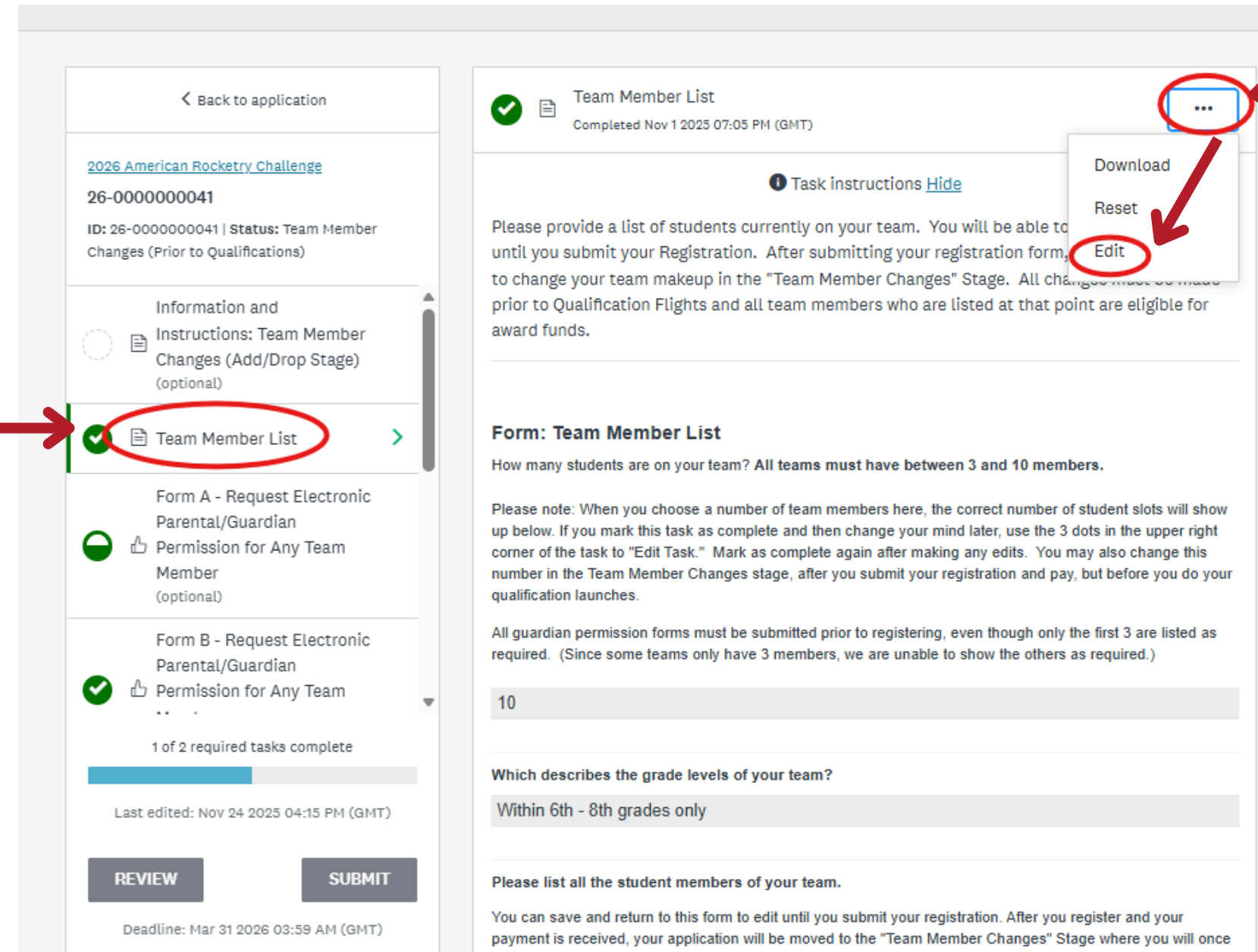
REVIEW SUBMIT

Deadline: Mar 31 2026 03:59 AM (GMT)

DO NOT REUSE REUSE

Edit Your Team Member List

SELECT A TASK



The screenshot displays the registration interface for the American Rocketry Challenge. On the left sidebar, under the heading '2026 American Rocketry Challenge' and ID '26-0000000041', there is a list of tasks. The 'Team Member List' task is highlighted with a red circle and a green checkmark, indicating it is the selected task. A red arrow points from the 'SELECT A TASK' label to this task. The main content area shows the 'Team Member List' form, which is titled 'Team Member List' and has a status of 'Completed Nov 1 2025 07:05 PM (GMT)'. The form includes a 'Task instructions' section, a 'Form: Team Member List' section with a question about the number of students, and a section for grade levels. A red arrow points from the 'EDIT' button in the top right corner to the 'Edit' option in the dropdown menu of the 'Team Member List' task. The dropdown menu also includes 'Download' and 'Reset' options.

Back to application

2026 American Rocketry Challenge
26-0000000041
ID: 26-0000000041 | Status: Team Member Changes (Prior to Qualifications)

Information and Instructions: Team Member Changes (Add/Drop Stage) (optional)

Team Member List

Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member (optional)

Form B - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member

1 of 2 required tasks complete

Last edited: Nov 24 2025 04:15 PM (GMT)

REVIEW SUBMIT

Deadline: Mar 31 2026 03:59 AM (GMT)

Team Member List
Completed Nov 1 2025 07:05 PM (GMT)

Task instructions Hide

Please provide a list of students currently on your team. You will be able to until you submit your Registration. After submitting your registration form, to change your team makeup in the "Team Member Changes" Stage. All changes must be made prior to Qualification Flights and all team members who are listed at that point are eligible for award funds.

Form: Team Member List

How many students are on your team? All teams must have between 3 and 10 members.

Please note: When you choose a number of team members here, the correct number of student slots will show up below. If you mark this task as complete and then change your mind later, use the 3 dots in the upper right corner of the task to "Edit Task." Mark as complete again after making any edits. You may also change this number in the Team Member Changes stage, after you submit your registration and pay, but before you do your qualification launches.

All guardian permission forms must be submitted prior to registering, even though only the first 3 are listed as required. (Since some teams only have 3 members, we are unable to show the others as required.)

10

Which describes the grade levels of your team?

Within 6th - 8th grades only

Please list all the student members of your team.

You can save and return to this form to edit until you submit your registration. After you register and your payment is received, your application will be moved to the "Team Member Changes" Stage where you will once

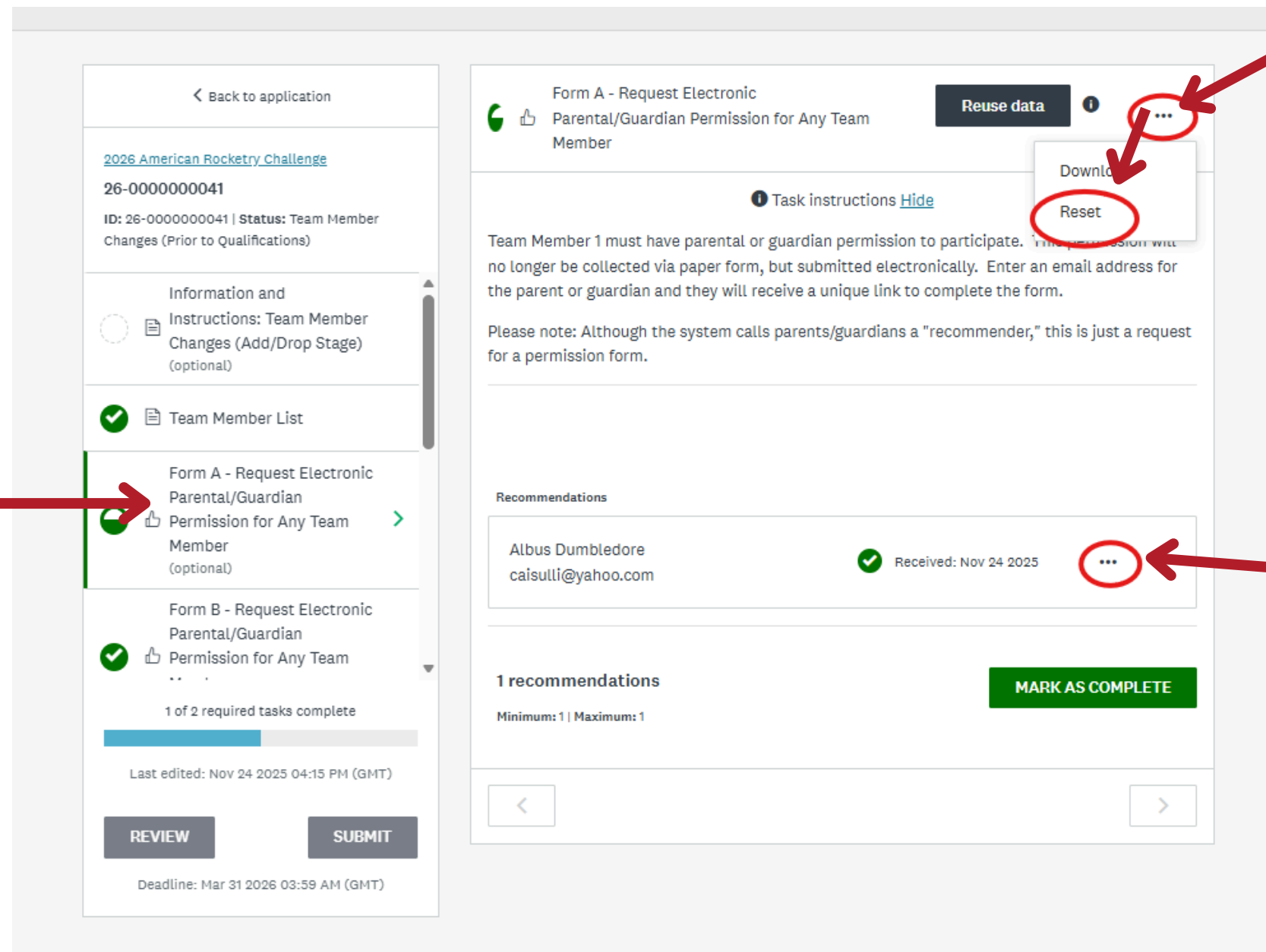
EDIT

Send a Reminder or Delete a Consent Form

SELECT A TASK

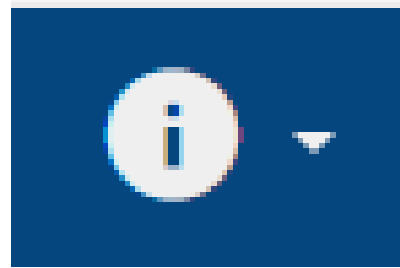
RESET (DELETE DATA)

SEND A REMINDER
OR WITHDRAW



The screenshot displays the American Rocketry Challenge web application interface. On the left, a sidebar lists tasks: '2026 American Rocketry Challenge' (ID: 26-0000000041), 'Information and Instructions: Team Member Changes (Add/Drop Stage) (optional)', 'Team Member List', 'Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member (optional)', and 'Form B - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member (optional)'. A red arrow points from the 'SELECT A TASK' label to the 'Form A' task. The main content area shows the details for 'Form A - Request Electronic Parental/Guardian Permission for Any Team Member'. It includes a 'Reuse data' button, a 'Task instructions' link, and a 'Reset' button (circled in red). A red arrow points from the 'RESET (DELETE DATA)' label to this button. Below the instructions, there is a 'Recommendations' section with one entry for 'Albus Dumbledore' (email: caisulli@yahoo.com) with a status of 'Received: Nov 24 2025'. A red arrow points from the 'SEND A REMINDER OR WITHDRAW' label to the three-dot menu icon next to this entry. At the bottom, there is a 'MARK AS COMPLETE' button and a progress bar showing '1 of 2 required tasks complete'.

Need Help?



Contact Technical Support Using the down arrow next to the icon in the upper right corner of any screen.



Email us at rocketrychallenge@aia-aerospace.org.



KEY DATES



JULY 15, 2025

**REGISTRATION
OPENS**

DECEMBER 6, 2025

**REGISTRATION & STEM
INNOVATION GRANT
APPLICATIONS CLOSE**

MARCH 6, 2025

**ROCKET REELS
ENTRIES DUE**

VIDEO CHALLENGE TO
GENERATE EXCITEMENT
ABOUT THE CHALLENGE
AND ROCKETRY

MARCH 30, 2026

**QUALIFICATION
FLIGHTS DUE**

MAY 6, 2026

**LAUNCHPAD
LEAGUE MILES
REPORTING DUE**

TEAMS EARN MILES FOR
ENGAGING IN CAREER-
CONNECTED WORKSHOPS,
COMPANY TOURS, AND MORE

APRIL 6, 2025

**NATIONAL
FINALISTS
ANNOUNCED**

APRIL 6, 2025

**MISSION
DEBRIEFING
CHALLENGE
ENTRIES DUE**

CHALLENGES TEAMS TO
EXPLAIN THEIR DESIGN
AND SHOW WHAT DROVE
DECISION MAKING

MAY 15, 2026

**ROCKETS ON
THE HILL**

~20 TEAMS SHOWCASE THEIR
ROCKETS TO MEMBERS OF
CONGRESS ON CAPITOL HILL

MAY 16, 2026

**NATIONAL
FINALS**

THE COUNTRY'S TOP 100
TEAMS COMPETE FOR
\$100,000 IN AWARDS,
AND THE TITLE OF
NATIONAL CHAMPION

JULY 2026

**INTERNATIONAL
ROCKETRY
CHALLENGE**

TEAM USA COMPETES AT
FARNBOROUGH AIR SHOW AGAINST
TEAMS FROM FRANCE, JAPAN, AND UK

